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Light irradiation device and light irradiation system

Abstract

A light irradiation device having an elongated shape is inserted into a catheter. The light irradiation device includes a light irradiation portion provided on a distal end side of a light irradiation device for outputting irradiation light to outside, and a large diameter portion positioned distal to the light irradiation portion and having an outer diameter larger than an outer diameter of the light irradiation portion.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a Bypass Continuation of PCT/JP2020/030984 filed Aug. 17, 2020, which is based upon and claims priority from JP 2019-172566 filed on Sep. 24, 2019, the entirety of the prior applications being hereby incorporated by reference into this application.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The disclosed embodiments relate to a light irradiation device and a light irradiation system.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) In cancer treatment, surgical, radiological, and pharmacological (chemical) methods are used alone or in combination, and development of each of these techniques is progressing in recent years. However, there are many cancers for which a satisfactory treatment technique has not yet been found, and further development of the treatment techniques is expected. A method called photodynamic therapy (PDT) is known as one of these cancer treatment techniques. In the PDT, a photosensitizer is administered intravenously and then irradiated with light, to generate reactive oxygen in cancer cells and kill the cancer cells (see, for example, Non-Patent Literature 1). However, in the PDT, the photosensitizer is accumulated with low selectivity in the cancer cells, so that the magnitude of the side effects caused by the uptake of the photosensitizer into normal cells is an issue, and thus, the PDT is not widely used as a treatment technique.

(3) Therefore, a treatment technique attracting attention in recent years is near-infrared photoimmunotherapy (NIR-PIT). The NIR-PIT uses a conjugate in which two compounds, an antibody against a specific antigen of cancer cells and a photosensitizer (for example, IRDye 700DX), are bound. When administered intravenously, this conjugate selectively accumulates in cancer cells in the body. Subsequently, if the conjugate is irradiated with light having an excitation wavelength (for example, 690 nm) of the photosensitizer in the conjugate, the conjugate is activated and exhibits an anticancer effect (see, for example, Patent Literature 1). Selective accumulation of the antibody in the cancer and local light irradiation in the NIR-PIT allow for reduction of side effects compared to the PDT. Further, in the NIR-PIT, irradiation with light in the near-infrared region of 690 nm (NIR irradiation) is performed, for example, and thus, an effect of the NIR irradiation on the immune system can also be expected (see, for example, Non-Patent Literature 2).

(4) A predetermined wavelength region including the 690 nm region in the example described above is also called a spectroscopic window of a living body. Although light in this wavelength region is absorbed less by biological components than light in other wavelength regions, the light does not sufficiently penetrate when light irradiation is performed from the body surface, and thus, there is a problem in that the NIR-PIT cannot be applied to cancers in a deep part inside the body. Therefore, in recent years, research is being conducted on the NIR-PIT in which light irradiation is performed at a position closer to cancer cells, instead of light irradiation from the body surface (see, for example, Non-Patent Literature 3). For example, Patent Literatures 2 to 5 disclose devices usable in such PDT and NIR-PIT. All of the devices described in Patent Literatures 2 to 5 are

inserted into a blood vessel for use and can be used to perform light irradiation in a deep part inside the body.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

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Non-Patent Literature

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SUMMARY

Technical Problem

(7) Here, in the PDT and the NIR-PIT, as described above, the cancer cells having the accumulated conjugate are irradiated with light of the excitation wavelength of the photosensitizer in the conjugate to kill the cancer cells. However, it is preferable to avoid irradiation to normal cells other than the cancer cells with light because this leads to blood coagulation and damage of normal cells.

(8) Further, in the PDT and the NIR-PIT, a light irradiation system separately provided with a catheter including a light transmitting portion transmitting light and a light irradiation device (a probe body) including a light irradiation portion outputting irradiation light may be used. In such a light irradiation system, the catheter usually has a tube shape for inserting a guide wire or a light irradiation device into the catheter. Therefore, when the catheter is inserted into a blood vessel ahead of the light irradiation device, blood infiltrates the inside of the catheter. In such a state, when the light irradiation device is inserted into the inside of the catheter to perform light irradiation, blood infiltrating the inside of the catheter is also inadvertently irradiated with light, which is not favorable. In this regard, in the devices described in Patent Literatures 2 to 5, in a technique in which a catheter and a light irradiation device are used in combination, no consideration is given to suppressing light irradiation to blood in the catheter.

(9) It is noted that such a problem is not limited to the PDT and the NIR-PIT, and is common to all devices used in examinations or treatments including a light irradiation process in the body.

Further, such a problem is not limited to devices inserted into a blood vessel, and is common to all devices inserted into living body lumens, such as the vascular system, the lymphatic system, the biliary system, the urinary system, the respiratory system, the digestive system, secretory glands, and reproductive organs.

(10) The disclosed embodiments have been contrived to solve at least a part of the above-mentioned problems, and an object of the disclosed embodiments is to suppress, in a technique in which a catheter and a light irradiation device are used in combination, light irradiation to body fluid in the catheter.

Solution to Problem

(11) The disclosed embodiments have been contrived to solve at least a part of the above-described problems, and can be implemented as the following aspects.

(12) (1) According to one aspect of the disclosed embodiments, a light irradiation device having an

elongated shape and being inserted into a catheter for use is provided. The light irradiation device includes a light irradiation portion being provided on a distal end side of the light irradiation device and outputting irradiation light to an outside, and a large diameter portion being distal to the light irradiation portion and having an outer diameter larger than an outer diameter of the light irradiation portion.

(13) According to this configuration, the light irradiation device inserted into the catheter for use includes the large diameter portion having an outer diameter larger than the outer diameter of the light irradiation portion. Therefore, when the light irradiation device is inserted into the catheter, body fluid infiltrating an inside of the catheter can be pushed out to the distal end side beyond the light irradiation portion by the large diameter portion distal to the light irradiation portion, and thus, the body fluid can be removed from a vicinity of the light irradiation portion. As a result, according to the light irradiation device of the present configuration, it is possible to suppress light irradiation of the body fluid in the catheter, and thus, the light irradiation device can contribute to the suppression of coagulation of the body fluid due to light irradiation and the suppression of damage to living tissue.

(14) (2) In the light irradiation device in the aspect described above, the large diameter portion may have a substantially columnar shape extending in a longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device, and a groove portion extending in the longitudinal direction may be formed on an outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion. According to this configuration, the groove portion extending in the longitudinal direction is formed on the outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion, and thus, if the groove portion is caused to function as an air discharge hole, the light irradiation device can be smoothly slid (moved in the longitudinal direction) in the catheter.

(15) (3) According to one aspect of the disclosed embodiments, a light irradiation system is provided. The light irradiation system includes the light irradiation device in the aspect described above and a catheter having an elongated tube shape into which the light irradiation device is inserted, the catheter may include a light transmitting portion being provided on a distal end side of the catheter and transmitting light inside a tube to the outside, and an inner diameter of the catheter may be equal to or larger than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.

(16) According to this configuration, it is possible to provide a light irradiation system in which the catheter including the light transmitting portion and the light irradiation device including the light irradiation portion are separately provided, and thus, the degree of freedom in designing the device can be improved and the range of procedures can be expanded. Further, the inner diameter of the catheter is equal to or larger than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device, so that the light irradiation device can be smoothly slid in the catheter.

(17) (4) In the light irradiation system in the aspect described above, the catheter may further include a through-hole being distal to the light transmitting portion and communicating the inside and outside of the tube.

(18) According to this configuration, the catheter is provided with the through-hole communicating the inside and outside of the tube, and thus, body fluid inside the catheter that is pushed out by the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device can be ejected to the outside of the catheter from the through-hole.

(19) (5) In the light irradiation system in the aspect described above, the through-hole of the catheter may communicate between the inside and outside of the tube in a longitudinal direction of the catheter, and an opening diameter of the through-hole may be smaller than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.

(20) According to this configuration, the through-hole of the catheter communicates between the inside and outside of the tube in the longitudinal direction of the catheter, and thus, the through-hole can also be used as an insertion port of a guide wire lumen for inserting a guide wire into the catheter.

(21) (6) In the light irradiation system in the aspect described above, a protruding portion to be engaged with the through-hole of the catheter may be formed on a distal end side of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.

(22) According to this configuration, when the light irradiation device is inserted into the catheter, the protruding portion formed on the distal end side of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device is engaged with the through-hole of the catheter, so that the light irradiation device and the catheter can be easily positioned in the long axis direction.

(23) (7) In the light irradiation system in the aspect described above, in a state where the light irradiation device is inserted into the catheter and the protruding portion is engaged with the through-hole, a length between an outer peripheral surface of the protruding portion and an inner peripheral surface of the through-hole may be shorter than a length between the outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion and an inner peripheral surface of the catheter.

(24) According to this configuration, the slidability of the light irradiation device in the catheter can be improved, and the light irradiation device and the catheter can be surely positioned in the long axis direction.

(25) It is noted that the disclosed embodiments can be realized in various aspects, for example, the disclosed embodiments can be realized in aspects such as a catheter, a light irradiation device, a light irradiation system provided with the catheter and the light irradiation device separately or integrally, and a manufacturing method of the catheter, the light irradiation device, and the light irradiation system.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a first embodiment.

(2) FIG. 2 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line A-A of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line B-B of FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line C-C of FIG. 1.

(5) FIG. 5 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line D-D of FIG. 1.

(6) FIG. 6 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a usage state of the light irradiation system.

(7) FIG. 7 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a usage state of the light irradiation system.

(8) FIG. 8 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a second embodiment.

(9) FIG. 9 is an explanatory table showing combinations of a light transmitting portion and a light irradiation portion.

(10) FIG. 10 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a transverse sectional configuration of a distal tip according to a third embodiment.

(11) FIG. 11 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a fourth embodiment.

(12) FIG. 12 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a fifth embodiment.

(13) FIG. 13 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a sixth embodiment.

(14) FIG. 14 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system

according to a seventh embodiment.

(15) FIG. 15 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to an eighth embodiment.

(16) FIG. 16 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a ninth embodiment.

(17) FIG. 17 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a tenth embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

First Embodiment

(18) FIG. 1 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a first embodiment. The light irradiation system is a system for irradiating living tissue with light, from inside the living body lumen by being inserted for use into a living body lumen such as the vascular system, the lymphatic system, the biliary system, the urinary system, the respiratory system, the digestive system, secretory glands, and reproductive organs. The light irradiation system can be used in photodynamic therapy (PDT) and near-infrared photoimmunotherapy (NIR-PIT), for example. In the following embodiments, laser light is described as an example of light, but the light being used is not limited to the laser light and the light irradiation system may have a configuration employing LED light or white light, for example. The light irradiation system includes a catheter **1** and a light irradiation device **2** to be inserted into the catheter **1** for use. In FIG. 1, the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2** are illustrated separately.

(19) In FIG. 1, an axis passing through a center of the catheter **1** and an axis passing through a center of the light irradiation device **2** are represented by an axis O (dash-dot-dash line). Hereinafter, in a state where the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**, it is assumed that axes passing through the centers of the light irradiation device **2** and the catheter **1** coincide with the axis O, but the axes passing through the centers of the light irradiation device **2** and the catheter **1** when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1** may be different from each other. Further, in FIG. 1, an X-axis, a Y-axis, and a Z-axis that are orthogonal to each other are illustrated. The X-axis corresponds to a longitudinal direction of the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2** (a direction of the axis O), the Y-axis corresponds to a height direction of the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2**, and the Z-axis corresponds to a width direction of the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2**. The left side (a $-X$ -axis direction) in FIG. 1 is referred to as a “distal end side” of the catheter **1**, the light irradiation device **2**, and each constitution component, and the right side (a $+X$ -axis direction) in FIG. 1 is referred to as a “proximal end side” of the catheter **1**, the light irradiation device **2**, and each constitution component. Further, end portions of the catheter **1**, the light irradiation device **2**, and each constitution component located on the distal end side are referred to as a “distal end”, and the distal end and a vicinity thereof are referred to as a “distal end portion”. Moreover, end portions of the catheter **1**, the light irradiation device **2**, and each constitution component located on the proximal end side are referred to as a “proximal end”, and the proximal end and a vicinity thereof are referred to as a “proximal end portion”. The distal end side corresponds to a “distal side” inserted into a living body, and the proximal end side corresponds to a “proximal side” operated by an operator such as a doctor. These features are common to each drawing in FIG. 1 and following illustrating an overall configuration.

(20) The catheter **1** has an elongated tube shape and includes a shaft **110**, a distal tip **120**, and a connector **140**. The shaft **110** is an elongated member extending along the axis O. The shaft **110** has a substantially hollow cylindrical shape (a tube shape) and both ends of the shaft **110**, i.e., a distal end portion **110d** and a proximal end portion **110p**, are open. The shaft **110** includes a lumen **110L** inside the shaft **110**. The lumen **110L** functions as a guide wire lumen for inserting a guide wire through the catheter **1** during delivery of the catheter **1**. The lumen **110L** functions as a device

lumen for inserting the light irradiation device 2 into the catheter 1 after the delivery of the catheter 1. Using a single lumen serving as both the guide wire lumen and the device lumen, as described above, makes it possible to reduce the diameter of the catheter 1. The shaft 110 may have any outer diameter, inner diameter, and length.

(21) FIG. 2 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line A-A of FIG. 1. The distal tip 120 is a member that is joined to the distal end portion of the shaft 110 and advances in a living body lumen ahead of other members. As illustrated in FIG. 1, to facilitate progress of the catheter 1 in the living body lumen, the distal tip 120 has an outer shape with a diameter decreasing from the proximal end side to the distal end side. Further, as illustrated in FIG. 2, a through-hole 120h penetrating the distal tip 120 in the direction of the axis O is formed in a substantially central part of the distal tip 120. In other words, the through-hole 120h communicates between the inside and outside of the shaft 110 in the longitudinal direction (the direction of the axis O) of the catheter 1. Here, an opening diameter $\phi 1$ of the through-hole 120h is smaller than an inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the lumen 110L of the shaft 110. Therefore, as illustrated in FIG. 1, at a boundary between the shaft 110 and the distal tip 120, an inner surface 120i of the distal tip 120 protrudes to form a step. An opening 120o of the distal tip 120 leads to the through-hole 120h and is used when inserting a guide wire (not illustrated) into the catheter 1. The distal tip 120 may have any outer diameter and length.

(22) The connector 140 is a member arranged on the proximal end side of the catheter 1 and gripped by the operator. The connector 140 includes a connection portion 141 having a substantially hollow cylindrical shape and a pair of blades 142. A distal end portion of the connection portion 141 is joined to the proximal end portion 110p of the shaft 110, and a proximal end portion of the connection portion 141 is joined with the blades 142. The blades 142 and the connector 140 may be integrated. An opening 140o of the connector 140 leads to the lumen 110L via the inside of the connector 140, and is used when inserting the light irradiation device 2 into the catheter 1. The connection portion 141 may have any outer diameter, inner diameter, and length, and the blades 142 may have any shape.

(23) FIG. 3 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line B-B of FIG. 1. The shaft 110 of the catheter 1 is further provided with a light transmitting portion 139 and first marker portions 131 and 132. The light transmitting portion 139 transmits light inside the shaft 110 to the outside. As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 3, the light transmitting portion 139 is a hollow member having a substantially hollow cylindrical shape, has an outer diameter substantially the same as the outer diameter of the shaft 110, and an inner diameter substantially the same as the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the lumen 110L of the shaft 110. In other words, the light transmitting portion 139 is provided over the entire circumference, and transmits light inside the shaft 110 to the outside over the entire circumference. The light transmitting portion 139 is joined to the shaft 110 at each of the proximal end side and the distal end side. The light transmitting portion 139 can be formed of a transparent resin material having light-transmitting properties, such as an acrylic resin, polyethylene terephthalate, and polyvinyl chloride.

(24) The first marker portions 131 and 132 function as marks indicating positions of the light transmitting portion 139. The first marker portion 131 is provided close to the distal end portion of the light transmitting portion 139, and functions as a mark indicating a position of the distal end portion of the light transmitting portion 139. The first marker portion 132 is provided close to the proximal end portion of the light transmitting portion 139, and functions as a mark indicating a position of the proximal end portion of the light transmitting portion 139. The first marker portions 131 and 132 are hollow members each having a substantially hollow cylindrical shape. In the example of FIG. 1, the first marker portions 131 and 132 are respectively arranged in recess portions formed on an outer surface of the shaft 110 and are joined to the outer surface of the shaft 110. In other words, the first marker portions 131 and 132 are each embedded in the outer surface of the shaft 110 to surround the shaft 110 in the circumferential direction. It is noted that the first

marker portions **131** and **132** may be joined to the outer surface of the shaft **110** without the recess portions, and may protrude from the outer surface of the shaft **110**. At least one of the first marker portions **131** and **132** may be omitted.

(25) The light irradiation device **2** has an elongated shape and includes a shaft **210**, a distal tip **220**, and a connector **240**. The shaft **210** is an elongated member extending along the axis O. The shaft **210** has a bottomed cylindrical shape having a closed distal end portion and an open proximal end portion. The shaft **210** includes a lumen **210L** inside the shaft **210**. An optical fiber **250** is inserted into and fixed to the lumen **210L**. A proximal end portion of the optical fiber **250** is directly connected via a connector (not illustrated) or indirectly connected via another optical fiber, to a laser light generator **3** configured to generate laser light of any wavelength. At a distal end portion of the optical fiber **250**, a clad and a coating are removed from the optical fiber to expose a core of the optical fiber **250**.

(26) FIG. **4** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line C-C of FIG. **1**. The distal tip **220** is a member that is joined to the distal end portion of the shaft **210** and advances ahead of other members in the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1**. As illustrated in FIG. **1**, the distal tip **220** is a member having a substantially columnar shape extending in the longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device **2**. Here, an outer diameter $\phi 3$ (FIGS. **1** and **4**) of the distal tip **220** is larger than an outer diameter $\phi 4$ of the shaft **210** and a light irradiation portion **239** ($\phi 3 > \phi 4$). Further, it is preferable that the outer diameter $\phi 3$ of the distal tip **220** is larger than the opening diameter $\phi 1$ of the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** and is equal to or less than the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the shaft **110** and the light transmitting portion **139** of the catheter **1** ($\phi 1 < \phi 3 \leq \phi 2$). The distal tip **220** functions as a “large diameter portion” that pushes out body fluid infiltrating the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1** toward the distal end side from the light irradiation portion **239** when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**. Details are described later.

(27) The connector **240** is a member arranged on the proximal end side of the light irradiation device **2** and gripped by the operator. The connector **240** includes a connection portion **241** having a substantially hollow cylindrical shape and a pair of blades **242**. A distal end portion of the connection portion **241** is joined to a proximal end portion of the shaft **210**, and a proximal end portion of the connection portion **241** is joined with the blades **242**. The blades **242** and the connector **240** may be integrated.

(28) FIG. **5** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a cross-sectional configuration taken along line D-D of FIG. **1**. The shaft **210** of the light irradiation device **2** is further provided with the light irradiation portion **239** and second marker portions **231** and **232**. The light irradiation portion **239** outputs, for irradiation, emission light LT from the core exposed at the distal end portion of the optical fiber **250**, to the outside in one direction (FIG. **5**: white arrows) of a side surface of the light irradiation device **2**. As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the light irradiation portion **239** is a resin body that covers a distal end of the core of the optical fiber **250** and is provided to be exposed in a part of a side surface of the shaft **210**. The light irradiation portion **239** can be formed, for example, by applying fine quartz powder to a dispersed acrylic ultraviolet-curable resin and curing the resultant resin with ultraviolet light. It is noted that the light irradiation portion **239** may be realized in another manner, and may be realized, for example, by a light-reflecting mirror, instead of the resin body. Further, the core exposed at the distal end portion of the optical fiber **250** may be subjected to a well-known process (for example, a process of diagonally cutting a distal end surface, a process of forming a notch, a sandblast process, and a chemical process), to form the light irradiation portion **239** in a part of the optical fiber **250**.

(29) Laser light LT generated by the laser light generator **3** is transmitted from the proximal end side to the distal end side of the optical fiber **250** via the core of the optical fiber, and is output, for irradiation, from the core exposed at the distal end portion via the light irradiation portion **239** to the outside, in one direction (FIG. **5**: white arrows) of the side surface of the light irradiation device

2.

(30) The second marker portions **231** and **232** function as marks indicating positions of the light irradiation portion **239**. The second marker portion **231** is provided close to the distal end portion of the light irradiation portion **239**, and functions as a mark indicating a position of the distal end portion of the light irradiation portion **239**. The second marker portion **232** is provided close to the proximal end portion of the light irradiation portion **239**, and functions as a mark indicating a position of the proximal end portion of the light irradiation portion **239**. The second marker portions **231** and **232** are hollow members each having a substantially hollow cylindrical shape. In the example of FIG. 1, the second marker portions **231** and **232** are respectively arranged in recess portions formed on an outer surface of the shaft **210** and are joined to the outer surface of the shaft **210**. In other words, the second marker portions **231** and **232** are each embedded in the outer surface of the shaft **210** to surround the shaft **210** in a circumferential direction. It is noted that the second marker portions **231** and **232** may be joined to the outer surface of the shaft **210** without the recess portions, and may protrude from the outer surface of the shaft **210**. At least one of the second marker portions **231** and **232** may be omitted.

(31) The first marker portions **131** and **132** of the catheter **1** and the second marker portions **231** and **232** of the light irradiation device **2** may be formed of a radiopaque resin material or a radiopaque metal material. For example, when a resin material is used, the first marker portions **131** and **132** and the second marker portions **231** and **232** may be formed by mixing a radiopaque material such as bismuth trioxide, tungsten, or barium sulfate with a polyamide resin, a polyolefin resin, a polyester resin, a polyurethane resin, a silicon resin, a fluororesin, or the like. For example, when a metal material is used, the first marker portions **131** and **132** and the second marker portions **231** and **232** may be formed of a radiopaque material such as gold, platinum, tungsten, or an alloy containing these elements (for example, a platinum-nickel alloy).

(32) The shaft **110** of the catheter **1** and the shaft **210** of the light irradiation device **2** are preferably antithrombotic, flexible, and biocompatible, and may be formed of a resin material or a metal material. Examples of the resin material may include a polyamide resin, a polyolefin resin, a polyester resin, a polyurethane resin, a silicon resin, and a fluororesin. Examples of the metal material may include stainless steel such as SUS304, a nickel-titanium alloy, a cobalt-chromium alloy, and tungsten steel. Further, the shaft **110** and the shaft **210** can be formed as a bonded structure obtained by combining a plurality of the above-mentioned materials. The distal tip **120** of the catheter **1** and the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** are preferably flexible, and may be formed of, for example, a resin material such as polyurethane and a polyurethane elastomer. The connector **140** of the catheter **1** and the connector **240** of the light irradiation device **2** may be formed of a resin material such as polyamide, polypropylene, polycarbonate, polyacetal, and polyether sulfone.

(33) FIGS. 6 and 7 are explanatory diagrams illustrating a usage state of the light irradiation system. FIG. 6 illustrates an overall view when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**, and FIG. 7 illustrates an enlarged view of a part of the distal end side of the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2** in the living body lumen. A method of using the light irradiation system will be described with reference to FIGS. 1, 6, and 7.

(34) First, an operator inserts a guide wire into a living body lumen. Next, the operator inserts a proximal end side of the guide wire from the opening **120o** of the distal tip **120** of the catheter **1** illustrated in FIG. 1, via the through-hole **120h**, through the lumen **110L**, so that the guide wire protrudes from the opening **140o** of the connector **140**. Subsequently, the operator pushes the catheter **1** into the living body lumen along the guide wire, and the light transmitting portion **139** of the catheter **1** is delivered to a target site for light irradiation (for example, in the case of NIR-PIT, a vicinity of a cancer cell). Thus, by inserting the guide wire from the through-hole **120h** formed in the distal tip **120** of the catheter **1**, the operator can easily deliver the catheter **1** to the target site in the living body lumen. During delivery, the operator can position the catheter **1** in the living body

lumen, while checking, in an X-ray image, the positions of the first marker portions **131** and **132** arranged in the vicinity of the light transmitting portion **139**. Afterwards, the operator removes the guide wire from the catheter **1**. It is noted that, when the catheter **1** is inserted into the living body lumen, body fluid flowing in the living body lumen (for example, blood flowing through a blood vessel) infiltrates the inside of the lumen **110L** via the through-hole **120h** of the distal tip **120**.

(35) Next, as illustrated in FIG. **6**, the operator inserts the light irradiation device **2** from the opening **140o** of the connector **140** of the catheter **1**. The operator pushes the light irradiation device **2** toward the distal end side of the catheter **1**, along the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1**. Here, as described above, the outer diameter $\phi 3$ of the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) of the light irradiation device **2** is larger than the outer diameter $\phi 4$ of the shaft **210** and the light irradiation portion **239** (FIG. **1**: $\phi 3 > \phi 4$). Therefore, as illustrated by white arrows in FIG. **7**, body fluid **3** infiltrating the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1** can be pushed out to the distal end side from the light irradiation portion **239** by the distal tip **220** distal to the light irradiation portion **239**, and thus, the body fluid **3** can be removed from the vicinity of the light irradiation portion **239**. In the illustrated example, the catheter **1** is formed with the through-hole **120h** communicating the inside and outside of the tube in the longitudinal direction. Thus, the body fluid **3** pushed out by the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** can be ejected to the outside of the catheter **1** from the through-hole **120h**.

(36) Further, as described above, the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the catheter **1** is equal to or larger than the outer diameter $\phi 3$ of the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** (FIG. **1**: $\phi 3 \leq \phi 2$). Therefore, the light irradiation device **2** can be smoothly slid in the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1**. Further, as described above, the outer diameter $\phi 3$ of the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** is larger than the opening diameter $\phi 1$ of the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** (FIG. **1**: $\phi 1 < \phi 3$). Therefore, a distal end surface **220e** of the light irradiation device **2** abuts against the inner surface **120i** of the distal tip **120** when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**, and thus, it is possible to prevent the light irradiation device **2** from being advanced beyond the distal end side of the catheter **1** (FIG. **6**).

(37) After that, the operator aligns the light irradiation portion **239** with the light transmitting portion **139** in the direction of the axis O (X-axis direction), while checking, in an X-ray image, a positional relationship between the first marker portions **131** and **132** and the second marker portions **231** and **232**. Thus, the laser light LT transmitted via the optical fiber **250** and emitted from the light irradiation portion **239** can be transmitted through the light transmitting portion **139** of the catheter **1** and emitted to living tissue on the outside. It is noted that, in the catheter **1** of the present embodiment, the light transmitting portion **139** is provided over the entire circumference (FIG. **3**). Therefore, in the light irradiation system of the present embodiment, the operator only needs to achieve alignment between the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation portion **239** in the direction of the axis O (X-axis direction), and does not need to achieve alignment between the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation portion **239** in the circumferential direction.

(38) As described above, according to the light irradiation system of the first embodiment, the light irradiation device **2** inserted into the catheter **1** for use includes the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) having the outer diameter $\phi 3$ larger than the outer diameter $\phi 4$ of the light irradiation portion **239**. Therefore, when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**, the body fluid **3** infiltrating the inside of the catheter **1** can be pushed out to the distal end side from the light irradiation portion **239** by the distal tip **220** distal to the light irradiation portion **239**, and thus, the body fluid **3** can be removed from the vicinity of the light irradiation portion **239** (FIG. **7**). As a result, according to the light irradiation device **2** of the first embodiment, it is possible to suppress light irradiation of the body fluid **3** in the catheter **1**, and thus, the light irradiation device **2** can contribute to the suppression of coagulation of the body fluid **3** by light irradiation and the suppression of damage to living tissue.

(39) Further, according to the light irradiation system of the first embodiment, the catheter **1** is provided with the through-hole **120h** communicating the inside and outside of the tube, and thus, the body fluid **3** in the catheter **1** that is pushed out by the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) of the light irradiation device **2**, can be ejected to the outside of the catheter **1** from the through-hole **120h** (FIG. 7). Moreover, the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** communicates between the inside and outside of the tube in the longitudinal direction of the catheter **1**. Therefore, as described above in the method of using the light irradiation system, the through-hole **120h** can also be used as an insertion port of the guide wire lumen for inserting the guide wire into the catheter **1**.

(40) Further, according to the light irradiation system of the first embodiment, it is possible to provide a light irradiation system in which the catheter **1** including the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation device **2** including the light irradiation portion **239** are separately provided, and thus, the degree of freedom in designing the device can be improved and the range of procedures can be expanded. Moreover, the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the catheter **1** is equal to or larger than the outer diameter $\phi 3$ of the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) of the light irradiation device **2**, so that the light irradiation device **2** can be smoothly slid in the catheter **1**. Further, in the catheter **1**, using the single lumen **110L** serving as both the guide wire lumen and a lumen for the light irradiation device **2** makes it possible to reduce the diameter of the catheter **1**.

Second Embodiment

(41) FIG. 8 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a second embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the second embodiment includes a catheter **1A** and a light irradiation device **2A** having configurations different from those of the first embodiment.

(42) The catheter **1A** includes a light transmitting portion **139A** instead of the light transmitting portion **139**. The light transmitting portion **139A** is a plate-like member having an arc shape, and is fitted into a part of the shaft **110** to be joined to the shaft **110**. Thus, the light transmitting portion **139A** of the second embodiment is provided partially in the circumferential direction, and from the part in the circumferential direction, transmits light inside the shaft **110** to the outside. It is noted that the light transmitting portion **139A** can be formed of a similar material to the light transmitting portion **139**.

(43) The light irradiation device **2A** includes a light irradiation portion **239A** instead of the light irradiation portion **239**. The light irradiation portion **239A** is a solid, substantially columnar member having a diameter that is substantially the same as the outer diameter of the shaft **210**. The light irradiation portion **239A** is joined to the shaft **210** at each of the proximal end side and the distal end side. Further, a surface of the light irradiation portion **239A** at the proximal end side covers an exposed distal end of the core of the optical fiber **250**. Therefore, in the light irradiation device **2A**, the laser light LT generated by the laser light generator **3** is output, for irradiation, to the outside from the entire circumference of the light irradiation device **2A** via the light irradiation portion **239A**.

(44) A method of using the light irradiation system of the second embodiment is similar to that of the first embodiment. In the light irradiation system of the second embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. 8, the light transmitting portion **139A** of the catheter **1A** is provided partially in the circumferential direction, whereas the light irradiation portion **239A** of the light irradiation device **2A** is provided over the entire circumference. Similarly to the first embodiment, in the light irradiation system according to the second embodiment, when the light irradiation device **2A** is inserted into the catheter **1A**, body fluid infiltrating the inside of the catheter **1A** can be pushed out to the distal end side from the light irradiation portion **239A** by the distal tip **220** distal to the light irradiation portion **239A**, and thus, the body fluid can be removed from the vicinity of the light irradiation portion **239A**.

(45) FIG. 9 is an explanatory table showing combinations of the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation portion **239**. As shown in FIG. 9, any combination between the light

transmitting portion **139** described in the first embodiment and the light transmitting portion **139A** described in the second embodiment, and the light irradiation portion **239** described in the first embodiment and the light irradiation portion **239A** described in the second embodiment is possible. That is, as shown in No. **1**, the light irradiation system may have a configuration in which the light transmitting portion **139** (FIG. **1**) that transmits light over the entire circumference and the light irradiation portion **239** (FIG. **1**) that outputs irradiation light partially in the circumferential direction are combined. Further, as shown in No. **2**, the light irradiation system may have a configuration in which the light transmitting portion **139A** (FIG. **8**) that transmits light partially in the circumferential direction and the light irradiation portion **239A** (FIG. **8**) that outputs irradiation light over the entire circumference are combined. Moreover, as shown in No. **3**, the light irradiation system may have a configuration in which the light transmitting portion **139** (FIG. **1**) that transmits light over the entire circumference and the light irradiation portion **239A** (FIG. **8**) that outputs irradiation light over the entire circumference are combined. Further, as shown in No. **4**, the light irradiation system may have a configuration in which the light transmitting portion **139A** (FIG. **8**) that transmits light partially in the circumferential direction and the light irradiation portion **239** (FIG. **1**) that outputs irradiation light partially in the circumferential direction are combined. According to the light irradiation system of the second embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first embodiment described above can be also achieved.

Third Embodiment

(46) FIG. **10** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a transverse sectional configuration of a distal tip **220B** according to a third embodiment (FIG. **1**: cross-sectional configuration along line C-C). The light irradiation system according to the third embodiment includes the catheter **1** described in the first embodiment, and a light irradiation device **2B** having a configuration different from that of the first embodiment.

(47) The light irradiation device **2B** includes the distal tip **220B** instead of the distal tip **220**. Similarly to the first embodiment, the distal tip **220B** is a member having a substantially columnar shape extending in the longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device **2B**. Groove portions **221** extending in the longitudinal direction (the direction of the axis O) are formed on an outer peripheral surface of the distal tip **220B**. The groove portions **221** extend linearly from the distal end surface **220e** of the distal tip **220B** to a proximal end surface (FIG. **1**: an end surface on the +X-axis side), and enable the flow of gas (for example, air) between the distal end side and the proximal end side of the distal tip **220B**. An opening area of the groove portions **221** can be determined freely. However, it is preferable that the opening area of the groove portions **221** has a size at which the body fluid **3** (FIG. **7**) does not easily flow in the catheter **1**, and gas can flow in the catheter **1**. In the illustrated example, four of the groove portions **221** arranged at intervals of about 90 degrees in the circumferential direction are formed on the outer peripheral surface of the distal tip **220B**.

(48) As described above, the configuration of the distal tip **220B** of the light irradiation device **2B** can be modified in various ways, and one or a plurality of the groove portions **221** may be formed on the outer peripheral surface of the distal tip **220B**. The number, arrangement, transverse sectional shape, and opening area of the groove portions **221** can be determined freely. Further, the groove portions **221** are arranged on the outer peripheral surface of the distal tip **220B**, and may not be linear as long as the groove portions **221** extend in the longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device **2B**, and may have a wavelike shape or a bellows shape. According to the light irradiation system of the third embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first embodiment described above can be also achieved. Further, according to the light irradiation system of the third embodiment, the groove portions **221** extending in the longitudinal direction are formed on the outer peripheral surface of the distal tip **220B** (the large diameter portion) of the light irradiation device **2B**. Therefore, if the groove portions **221** are caused to function as air discharge holes, the light irradiation device **2B** can be smoothly slid (moved in the longitudinal

direction) in the catheter **1**.

Fourth Embodiment

(49) FIG. **11** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a fourth embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the fourth embodiment includes the catheter **1** described in the first embodiment, and a light irradiation device **2C** having a configuration different from that of the first embodiment.

(50) The light irradiation device **2C** does not include the distal tip **220** and includes a shaft **210C** instead of the shaft **210**. A part of the shaft **210C** distal to the light irradiation portion **239** functions as a large diameter portion. Specifically, a part of the shaft **210C** distal to the light irradiation portion **239** has a tapered shape having the outer diameter increasing from the proximal end side toward the distal end side. An outer diameter $\phi 31$ of a distal end surface **210e** of the shaft **210C** is larger than the outer diameter $\phi 4$ of the light irradiation portion **239** ($\phi 31 > \phi 4$). Further, it is preferable that the outer diameter $\phi 31$ of the distal end surface **210e** of the shaft **210C** is larger than the opening diameter $\phi 1$ of the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** and is equal to or less than the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the shaft **110** and the light transmitting portion **139** of the catheter **1** ($\phi 1 < \phi 31 \leq \phi 2$).

(51) As described above, the configuration of the light irradiation device **2C** can be modified in various ways, and the distal tip **220** described in the first embodiment may not be provided, and a large diameter portion may be formed in a part of the shaft **210C**. The large diameter portion may be provided at any position in the shaft **210C**, as long as the position is distal to the light irradiation portion **239**, and is not limited to the distal end surface **210e**. According to the light irradiation system of the fourth embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first embodiment described above can be also achieved. Further, according to the light irradiation system of the fourth embodiment, the number of parts in the light irradiation device **2C** can be reduced, and thus, it is possible to reduce the manufacturing cost of the light irradiation device **2C**.

Fifth Embodiment

(52) FIG. **12** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a fifth embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the fifth embodiment includes the catheter **1** described in the first embodiment, and a light irradiation device **2D** having a configuration different from that of the first embodiment.

(53) The light irradiation device **2D** includes a distal tip **220D** instead of the distal tip **220**, and further includes a valve body **270**. The distal tip **220D** has an outer diameter $\phi 4$ that is substantially the same as that of the shaft **210** and the light irradiation portion **239**, and the large diameter portion is not formed. The valve body **270** is a substantially circular plate-like member formed of an elastic body, and one side thereof is joined to the distal end surface **220e** of the distal tip **220D**. For the joining, any bonding agent such as an epoxy-based adhesive may be used. An outer diameter $\phi 32$ of the valve body **270** is larger than the outer diameter $\phi 4$ of the distal tip **220**, the shaft **210**, and the light irradiation portion **239** ($\phi 32 > \phi 4$). Further, the outer diameter $\phi 32$ of the valve body **270** is larger than the opening diameter $\phi 1$ of the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** and is larger than the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the shaft **110** and the light transmitting portion **139** of the catheter **1** ($\phi 1, \phi 2 < \phi 32$).

(54) According to the light irradiation system of the fifth embodiment, when the light irradiation device **2D** is inserted into the catheter **1**, an outer peripheral portion **271** of the valve body **270** bends as illustrated in the drawing to move along an inner wall of the shaft **110** of the catheter **1**. As a result, body fluid infiltrating the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1** can be pushed out more effectively. In the present embodiment, the valve body **270** functions as a “large diameter portion”.

(55) As described above, the configuration of the light irradiation device **2D** can be modified in various ways, and the large diameter portion may be formed by using a means other than the distal tip **220D** (for example, the valve body **270** described above). Above, it is assumed that the valve body **270** is joined to the distal tip **220D**, however, the valve body **270** may be joined to a distal end

surface of the shaft **210** (in this case, the distal tip **220D** may be omitted). Further, the valve body **270** may be formed in a part of the distal tip **220D** or a part of the shaft **210**. According to the light irradiation system of the fifth embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first embodiment described above can be achieved.

Sixth Embodiment

(56) FIG. **13** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a sixth embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the sixth embodiment includes the catheter **1** described in the first embodiment, and a light irradiation device **2E** having a configuration different from that of the first embodiment.

(57) The light irradiation device **2E** includes a distal tip **220E** instead of the distal tip **220**. The distal tip **220E** includes a large diameter portion **222** and a protruding portion **223**. The large diameter portion **222** has a configuration similar to that of the distal tip **220** described in the first embodiment. That is, the large diameter portion **222** is a substantially columnar member extending in the longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device **2E**, and an outer diameter $\phi 33$ of the large diameter portion **222** is larger than the outer diameter $\phi 4$ of the shaft **210** and the light irradiation portion **239** ($\phi 33 > \phi 4$). Further, the outer diameter $\phi 33$ of the large diameter portion **222** is larger than the opening diameter $\phi 1$ of the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** and is equal to or less than the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the shaft **110** and the light transmitting portion **139** of the catheter **1** ($\phi 1 < \phi 3 \leq \phi 2$).

(58) The protruding portion **223** is a member having a substantially columnar shape extending in the longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device **2E** and having a smaller diameter than the large diameter portion **222**. The protruding portion **223** is joined to the distal end surface **220e** of the large diameter portion **222** in a state where a center of the protruding portion **223** and a center of the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** are aligned with each other. For the joining, any bonding agent such as an epoxy-based adhesive may be used. It is noted that the large diameter portion **222** and the protruding portion **223** may be integrally formed. An outer diameter $\phi 5$ of the protruding portion **223** is equal to or less than the opening diameter $\phi 1$ of the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** ($\phi 5 \leq \phi 1$). According to the light irradiation system of the sixth embodiment, when the light irradiation device **2E** is inserted into the catheter **1**, the protruding portion **223** engages, as illustrated in the drawing, with the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1**, so that the light irradiation device **2E** and the catheter **1** can be positioned in a long axis direction (the direction of the axis O).

(59) As described above, the configuration of the light irradiation device **2E** can be modified in various ways, and in addition to the large diameter portion **222**, the protruding portion **223** to be engaged with the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1** may further be provided in a distal end portion of the light irradiation device **2E**. According to the light irradiation system of the sixth embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first embodiment described above can be achieved. Further, according to the light irradiation system of the sixth embodiment, when the light irradiation device **2E** is inserted into the catheter **1**, the protruding portion **223** formed on the distal end side of the large diameter portion **222** of the light irradiation device **2E** is engaged with the through-hole **120h** of the catheter **1**, so that the light irradiation device **2E** and the catheter **1** can be easily positioned in the long axis direction.

Seventh Embodiment

(60) FIG. **14** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a seventh embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the seventh embodiment includes the catheter **1** described in the first embodiment, and a light irradiation device **2F** having a configuration different from that of the sixth embodiment.

(61) The light irradiation device **2F** includes a large diameter portion **222F** instead of the large diameter portion **222**, and a protruding portion **223F** instead of the protruding portion **223**. The large diameter portion **222F** has an outer diameter $\phi 34$ different from the outer diameter described in the sixth embodiment. Similarly, the protruding portion **223F** has an outer diameter ϕ

51 different from the outer diameter described in the sixth embodiment. The outer diameter phi 34 of the large diameter portion 222F and the outer diameter phi 51 of the protruding portion 223F have sizes satisfying Expression (1) below.

$$(62) \{(\phi_1 - \phi_{51}) / 2\} < \{(\phi_2 - \phi_{34}) / 2\} \quad (1)$$

In other words, in the light irradiation system of the seventh embodiment, in a state where the light irradiation device 2F is inserted into the catheter 1 and the protruding portion 223F of the light irradiation device 2F is engaged with the through-hole 120h of the catheter 1, a length L1 between the outer peripheral surface of the protruding portion 223F and the inner peripheral surface of the through-hole 120h $((\phi_1 - \phi_{51}) / 2)$ is shorter than a length L2 between the outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion 222F and the inner peripheral surface of the catheter 1 $((\phi_2 - \phi_{34}) / 2)$.

(63) As described above, the configuration of the light irradiation device 2E can be modified in various ways, and in a configuration including the large diameter portion 222F and the protruding portion 223F, sizes of a gap between the large diameter portion 222F and the catheter 1 and a gap between the protruding portion 223F and the through-hole 120h may be different from each other. According to the light irradiation system of the seventh embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first and sixth embodiments described above can be achieved. Further, according to the light irradiation system of the seventh embodiment, the slidability of the light irradiation device 2F in the catheter 1 can be improved, and the light irradiation device 2F and the catheter 1 can be surely positioned in the long axis direction.

Eighth Embodiment

(64) FIG. 15 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to an eighth embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the eighth embodiment includes the catheter 1 described in the first embodiment, and a light irradiation device 2G having a configuration different from that of the sixth embodiment.

(65) The light irradiation device 2G includes a protruding portion 223G instead of the protruding portion 223. The protruding portion 223G is a member having a substantially conical shape extending in the longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device 2G. As for the protruding portion 223G, a bottom surface of the protruding portion 223G is joined to the distal end surface 220e of the large diameter portion 222 in a state where the rotation axis of the protruding portion 223G and the center of the through-hole 120h of the catheter 1 are aligned with each other. It is noted that the large diameter portion 222 and the protruding portion 223G may be integrally formed.

(66) As described above, the configuration of the light irradiation device 2G can be modified in various ways, and the shape of the protruding portion 223G to be engaged with the through-hole 120h of the catheter 1 is not limited to the conical shape, and various shapes such as a columnar shape and a triangular pyramid shape can be adopted. According to the light irradiation system of the eighth embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first and sixth embodiments described above can be achieved. Further, according to the light irradiation system of the eighth embodiment, the protruding portion 223G and the through-hole 120h can be engaged with each other at any position in accordance with the inner diameter of the through-hole 120h of the catheter 1.

Ninth Embodiment

(67) FIG. 16 is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a ninth embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the ninth embodiment includes a catheter 1H having a configuration different from that of the first embodiment, and the light irradiation device 2 described in the first embodiment. The catheter 1H includes a distal tip 120H instead of the distal tip 120. The through-hole 120h described in the first embodiment is not formed in the distal tip 120H.

(68) Also in the light irradiation system of the ninth embodiment, when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1H**, body fluid infiltrating the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1H** can be pushed out to the distal end side from the light irradiation portion **239** by the distal tip **220** distal to the light irradiation portion **239**, and thus, the body fluid can be removed from the vicinity of the light irradiation portion **239**. As described above, the configuration of the catheter **1H** can be modified in various ways, and the configuration may include a distal tip **220H** not including the through-hole **120h**. According to the light irradiation system of the ninth embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first embodiment described above can be achieved.

Tenth Embodiment

(69) FIG. **17** is an explanatory diagram illustrating a configuration of a light irradiation system according to a tenth embodiment. The light irradiation system according to the tenth embodiment includes a catheter **1I** having a configuration different from that of the ninth embodiment, and the light irradiation device **2** described in the first embodiment. The catheter **1I** includes a shaft **110I** instead of the shaft **110**. The shaft **110I** is formed with a through-hole **110o** communicating the inside and outside of the shaft **110** at any position distal to the light transmitting portion **139**.

(70) Also in the light irradiation system of the tenth embodiment, when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1I**, body fluid infiltrating the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1I** can be pushed out to the distal end side from the light irradiation portion **239** by the distal tip **220** distal to the light irradiation portion **239**, and thus, the body fluid can be removed from the vicinity of the light irradiation portion **239**. Further, the body fluid pushed out by the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** can be ejected to the outside of the catheter **1I** from the through-hole **110o** of the shaft **110I**. As described above, the configuration of the catheter **1I** can be modified in various ways, and the through-hole **110o** communicating the inside and outside of the tube may be provided in a separate member different from the distal tip **220H**, such as the shaft **110I**. According to the light irradiation system of the tenth embodiment described above, an effect similar to the first embodiment described above can be achieved.

(71) <Modifications of Embodiment>

(72) The disclosed embodiments are not limited to the above-described embodiments, and may be implemented in various modes without departing from the spirit of the disclosed embodiments. The following modifications can be applied, for example.

(73) [First Modification]

(74) In the first to tenth embodiments described above, examples of the configurations of the catheters **1**, **1A**, **1H**, and **1I** and the light irradiation devices **2** and **2A** to **2G** are illustrated.

However, the configurations of the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2** can be modified in various ways.

(75) For example, a reinforcing layer formed of a braided body or a coil body may be embedded in the shaft **110** of the catheter **1** and the shaft **210** of the light irradiation device **2**. Thus, it is possible to improve the torquability and the shape retention of the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2**. For example, a coating formed of a hydrophilic or hydrophobic resin may be applied to the outer surface of the catheter **1** and the outer surface of the light irradiation device **2**. Thus, the slidability of the catheter **1** in the living body lumen can be improved. Further, the slidability of the light irradiation device **2** in the lumen **110L** of the catheter **1** can be improved. Moreover, the outer surface of the catheter **1** or the outer surface of the light irradiation device **2** may be coated with an antithrombotic material such as heparin. This makes it possible to suppress a decrease in laser output due to thrombus adhesion to the inner and outer surfaces of the catheter **1** and the outer surface of the light irradiation device **2** caused by the irradiation with the emission light (laser light) LT.

(76) For example, the catheter **1** may include an expansion portion expandable in a radial direction (YZ-direction). For example, a balloon formed of a flexible thin film or a mesh body having wires arranged in a mesh shape can be used as the expansion portion. The expansion portion may be

provided on at least one of the distal end side of the light transmitting portion **139** and the proximal end side of the light transmitting portion **139** in the shaft **110**. Thus, after the catheter **1** is positioned in the living body lumen, the catheter **1** can be fixed in the living body lumen by expanding the expansion portion. Further, if a balloon is used as the expansion portion, the bloodstream at the site being irradiated with light can be blocked, and thus, it is possible to prevent that the bloodstream blocks the light.

(77) For example, the catheter **1** may be configured as a multi-lumen catheter including a plurality of lumens different from the lumen **110L**. Similarly, the light irradiation device **2** may be configured as a multi-lumen catheter including a separate lumen different from the lumen **210L** into which the optical fiber **250** is inserted. In this case, the shaft **210** can be formed by using a hollow member having a substantially hollow cylindrical shape, and the distal tip **220** can be provided with a through-hole extending along the direction of the axis **O**.

(78) For example, the inner surface of the distal tip **120** of the catheter **1** and the outer surface of the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** may be formed of a magnetic material and may be configured to attract each other. Thus, as illustrated in FIG. **6**, a state where the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1** and the distal tip **220** is pressed against the distal tip **120** can be easily maintained. For example, the distal tip **120** of the catheter **1** may be omitted, and a configuration in which the distal end side of the shaft **110** is open may be adopted. Thus, when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**, body fluid pushed out by the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) can be ejected to the outside of the catheter **1** from an open portion on the distal end side of the shaft **110**.

(79) [Second Modification]

(80) In the first to tenth embodiments described above, examples of the configurations of the distal tips **120** and **120H** of the catheter **1** and the distal tips **220**, **220B**, **220D**, **220E**, and **220H** (large diameter portions) of the light irradiation device **2** are illustrated. However, the configurations of the distal tip **120** of the catheter **1** and the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** can be modified in various ways. For example, the outer diameter $\phi 3$ of the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) of the light irradiation device **2** may be larger than the inner diameter $\phi 2$ of the shaft **110** and the light transmitting portion **139** of the catheter **1**. In this case, to improve the slidability of the light irradiation device **2** when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**, the distal tip **220** is preferably made of a material having an outer diameter expandable and contractible (for example, an elastic body and a porous body).

(81) For example, a mesh member may be arranged in the through-hole **120h** of the distal tip **120** of the catheter **1**. Thus, a coagulant body fluid (for example, a thrombus) generated in the catheter **1** can be captured while allowing for the guide wire to be inserted into the catheter **1**. As a result, body fluid pushed out by the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) of the light irradiation device **2** can be ejected to the outside of the catheter **1** while removal of the coagulant body fluid to the outside can be suppressed.

(82) [Third Modification]

(83) In the first to tenth embodiments described above, examples of the configurations of the light transmitting portions **139** and **139A** and the light irradiation portions **239** and **239A** are illustrated. However, the configurations of the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation portion **239** can be changed in various ways. For example, the light transmitting portion **139** may be formed of a radiopaque material, to integrally form the light transmitting portion **139** and the first marker portions **131** and **132**. Similarly, the light irradiation portion **239** may be formed of a radiopaque material, to integrally form the light irradiation portion **239** and the second marker portions **231** and **232**.

(84) For example, the light transmitting portion **139** may be formed by thinning a part of the shaft **110**. For example, at least one of the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation portion **239** may be formed as a notch (a through-hole communicating the inside and outside of the shaft)

formed in the shaft **110** or the shaft **210**. Thus, the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation portion **239** can be easily formed. Further, if the light transmitting portion **139** is formed as a notch, body fluid pushed out by the distal tip **220** (the large diameter portion) when the light irradiation device **2** is inserted into the catheter **1**, can be ejected to the outside of the catheter **1** from the light transmitting portion **139** (the notch).

(85) For example, ranges in which the light transmitting portion **139** is provided in the direction of the axis O (the X-axis direction) and the circumferential direction (a YZ-axis direction), and ranges in which the light irradiation portion **239** is provided in the direction of the axis O and the circumferential direction can be modified to any range. Specifically, the light transmitting portion **139** may be provided in a wide range in the direction of the axis O, for example.

(86) For example, the catheter **1** may further include a separate marker portion arranged at any position, such as the distal end side of the light transmitting portion **139** or the proximal end side of the light transmitting portion **139**. For example, the light irradiation device **2** may further include a separate marker portion arranged at any position, such as the distal end side of the light irradiation portion **239** or the proximal end side of the light irradiation portion **239**. The marker portions of the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2** may have any shape, including a shape wholly or partly extending in the circumferential direction (the YZ-direction), a shape extending in the direction of the axis O (the X-axis direction), and a shape surrounding a periphery of the shaft. Further, the distal tip **120** of the catheter **1** and the distal tip **220** of the light irradiation device **2** may be configured as a marker portion.

(87) For example, the distal end surface of the optical fiber **250** may be diagonally cut, and this distal end surface may be configured as the light irradiation portion **239**. For example, a light-reflecting mirror installed at an angle with respect to a cutting plane of the optical fiber **250** (a cutting plane provided perpendicular to the direction of the axis O) may be provided for use as the light irradiation portion **239**. For example, the optical fiber **250** may not be inserted into the shaft **210** and may be joined to the outer surface of the shaft **210**. For example, the shaft **210** may not include the lumen **210L**, and the shaft **210** may be provided to contact the outer surface of the optical fiber **250** and cover the outer surface of the optical fiber **250**.

(88) [Fourth Modification]

(89) The configurations of the catheters **1**, **1A**, **1H**, and **1I** and the light irradiation devices **2** and **2A** to **2G** of the first to tenth embodiments, and the configurations of the catheters **1**, **1A**, **1H**, and **1I** and the light irradiation devices **2** and **2A** to **2G** of the first to third modifications described above may be appropriately combined. For example, in the catheter **1** and the light irradiation device **2** employing various combinations of the light transmitting portion **139** and the light irradiation portion **239** described in the second embodiment (FIG. 9), a configuration including the distal tips and the shafts described in each of the third to tenth embodiments may be adopted. For example, the light irradiation devices **2B**, **2C**, and **2D** described in the third, fourth, and fifth embodiments may be used in combination with the catheters **1H** and **1I** described in the ninth and tenth embodiments.

(90) Although the aspects have been described based on the embodiments and the modifications, the embodiments of the above-described aspects are for facilitating understanding of the aspects, and do not limit the aspects. The aspects can be modified and improved without departing from the spirit of the aspects and the scope of the claims, and equivalent aspects are included in the aspects. Further, unless a technical feature is described as essential in the present specification, the technical feature may be omitted as appropriate.

DESCRIPTION OF REFERENCE NUMERALS

(91) **1**, **1A**, **1H**, **1I** . . . Catheter **2**, **2A** to **2G** . . . Light irradiation device **3** . . . Laser light generator **110**, **110I** . . . Shaft **110o** . . . Through-hole **120**, **120H** . . . Distal tip **120h** . . . Through-hole **131**, **132** . . . First marker portion **139**, **139A** . . . Light transmitting portion **140** . . . Connector **141** . . . Connection portion **142** . . . Blade **210**, **210C** . . . Shaft **220**, **220B**, **220D**, **220E**, **220H** . . . Distal tip

221 . . . Groove portion 222, 222F . . . Large diameter portion 223, 223F, 223G . . . Protruding portion 231, 232 . . . Second marker portion 239, 239A . . . Light irradiation portion 240 . . . Connector 241 . . . Connection portion 242 . . . Blade 250 . . . Optical fiber 270 . . . Valve body 271 . . . Outer peripheral portion

Claims

1. A light irradiation device having an elongated shape and configured to be inserted into a catheter, the light irradiation device comprising: a light irradiation portion provided on a distal end side of the light irradiation device and configured to output irradiation light to outside of the light irradiation device; and a large diameter portion positioned distal to the light irradiation portion and having an outer diameter larger than an outer diameter of the light irradiation portion, wherein the large diameter portion is configured to push out body fluid infiltrating a lumen of the catheter toward a distal end side from the light irradiation portion when the light irradiation device is inserted into the catheter.
2. The light irradiation device according to claim 1, wherein the large diameter portion has a columnar shape extending in a longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device, and a groove portion extending in the longitudinal direction is formed on an outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion.
3. A light irradiation system comprising: the light irradiation device according to claim 1; and a catheter having an elongated tube configured to receive the light irradiation device, wherein the catheter includes: a light transmitting portion provided on a distal end side of the catheter and configured to transmit light inside the tube to outside of the catheter, and an inner diameter of the catheter is equal to or larger than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.
4. The light irradiation device according to claim 1, wherein the large diameter portion positioned distal to the light irradiation portion has an outer diameter larger than an outer diameter of the light irradiation device at a position where the light irradiation portion is provided.
5. The light irradiation system according to claim 3, wherein the catheter further includes: a through-hole positioned distal to the light transmitting portion and communicating between an inside and an outside of the tube.
6. The light irradiation system according to claim 5, wherein in the catheter, the through-hole communicates between the inside and the outside of the tube in a longitudinal direction of the catheter, and an opening diameter of the through-hole is smaller than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.
7. The light irradiation system according to claim 6, wherein in the light irradiation device, a protruding portion configured to engage the through-hole of the catheter is provided on a distal end side of the large diameter portion.
8. The light irradiation system according to claim 7, wherein in a state where the light irradiation device is inserted into the catheter and the protruding portion engages the through-hole, a distance between an outer peripheral surface of the protruding portion and an inner peripheral surface of the through-hole in a radial direction of the catheter is shorter than a distance between an outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion and an inner peripheral surface of the catheter in the radial direction.
9. The light irradiation system according to claim 6, wherein in the light irradiation device, a protruding portion configured to be inserted into the through-hole of the catheter is provided on a distal end side of the large diameter portion.
10. The light irradiation system according to claim 3, wherein the inner diameter of the catheter is equal to the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.
11. A light irradiation device having an elongated shape and configured to be inserted into a

catheter, the light irradiation device comprising: a light irradiation portion provided on a distal end side of the light irradiation device and configured to output irradiation light to outside of the light irradiation device; and a large diameter portion positioned distal to the light irradiation portion and having an outer diameter larger than an outer diameter of the light irradiation device at a position where the light irradiation portion is provided.

12. The light irradiation device according to claim 11, wherein the large diameter portion has a columnar shape extending in a longitudinal direction of the light irradiation device, and a groove portion extending in the longitudinal direction is formed on an outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion.

13. A light irradiation system comprising: the light irradiation device according to claim 12; and a catheter having an elongated tube configured to receive the light irradiation device, wherein the catheter includes: a light transmitting portion provided on a distal end side of the catheter and configured to transmit light inside the tube to outside of the catheter, and an inner diameter of the catheter is equal to or larger than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.

14. A light irradiation system comprising: the light irradiation device according to claim 11; and a catheter having an elongated tube configured to receive the light irradiation device, wherein the catheter includes: a light transmitting portion provided on a distal end side of the catheter and configured to transmit light inside the tube to outside of the catheter, and an inner diameter of the catheter is equal to or larger than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.

15. The light irradiation system according to claim 14, wherein the catheter further includes: a through-hole positioned distal to the light transmitting portion and communicating between an inside and an outside of the tube.

16. The light irradiation system according to claim 15, wherein in the catheter, the through-hole communicates between the inside and the outside of the tube in a longitudinal direction of the catheter, and an opening diameter of the through-hole is smaller than the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.

17. The light irradiation system according to claim 16, wherein in the light irradiation device, a protruding portion configured to engage the through-hole of the catheter is provided on a distal end side of the large diameter portion.

18. The light irradiation system according to claim 17, wherein in a state where the light irradiation device is inserted into the catheter and the protruding portion engages the through-hole, a distance between an outer peripheral surface of the protruding portion and an inner peripheral surface of the through-hole in a radial direction of the catheter is shorter than a distance between an outer peripheral surface of the large diameter portion and an inner peripheral surface of the catheter in the radial direction.

19. The light irradiation system according to claim 16, wherein in the light irradiation device, a protruding portion configured to be inserted into the through-hole of the catheter is provided on a distal end side of the large diameter portion.

20. The light irradiation system according to claim 14, wherein the inner diameter of the catheter is equal to the outer diameter of the large diameter portion of the light irradiation device.
